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Meeting summary

Quick recap

Bhargab and Francis discussed a research project on rating distortion in consumer reviews, focusing on how platform cues and sentiment affect ratings. Bhargab explained the three main hypotheses testing whether platform cues increase rating sensitivity to sentiment and whether distortion varies across products and brands. They discussed the need to validate sentiment scores using BERT instead of the current Vader model due to computational limitations, and explored potential downstream consequences of rating distortion from an Information Systems perspective rather than a marketing angle. The conversation also touched on a separate project involving IOP (Intensive Outpatient Program) research, where Bhargab provided feedback on the need for better theoretical motivation regarding time period differences and interventions.

Next steps

Bhargab

- Send Francis the dictionary/variable definitions for the dataset by the weekend.

Francis

- Conduct sentiment analysis using BERT and compare results with existing Vader sentiment scores to assess the level of match (target: 80% match), and review the paper in detail.
- Review the updated results section of the IOP project before the next meeting.

Collaboration

- Francis and Bhargab: Schedule and hold a follow-up meeting to discuss the results of the sentiment analysis and next steps for both projects.

Summary

Consumer Review Rating Distortion Research

Bhargab and Francis discussed a research paper about rating distortion in consumer reviews. Bhargab explained that the research examines how factors like sentiment, other users' ratings,

and verified purchases affect rating distortion beyond just product experience. The discussion focused on analyzing whether there is a match between sentiment ratings and actual ratings to determine the extent of distortion.

Platform Queues and Rating Distortion

Bhargab presented the research model focusing on platform queues and their impact on rating distortion, including three main hypotheses about sentiment and platform queues. The discussion centered on a multi-level structure model examining whether distortion exists and what factors affect it, particularly platform queues. When Francis inquired about the computation of descriptive statistics for interaction terms, Bhargab explained they used the Vader sentiment analysis tool, which provides sentiment scores between minus 1 and plus 1.

Sentiment Analysis Methodology Discussion

Bhargab explained the methodology used in their analysis, including the computation of interaction terms and the implementation of quarter fixed effects rather than random effects. He discussed the results obtained using Vader for testing hypotheses 1, 2, and 3, and mentioned plans to explore BERT as an alternative method for sentiment analysis, referencing a paper by Quack et al.

Sentiment Analysis Model Performance Issues

Bhargab discussed performance issues with the current sentiment analysis model using Vader, which was taking 2-3 hours to process 500 rows on his laptop. He proposed comparing Vader's sentiment scores with BERT's scores to determine if they match sufficiently (around 80%) before proceeding. Bhargab also outlined three hypotheses related to rating distortion and its downstream consequences, suggesting these should be evaluated from an IES perspective rather than a marketing perspective.

IS Research Scope and Methodology

Bhargab discussed their research scope, which primarily focuses on the IS (Information Systems) domain, particularly in the IAS area and business analytics. They explained their approach of analyzing platform-level impacts rather than reviewer behavior, using platform variables like verified purchases and image aspects as key factors. Bhargab outlined plans for exploratory research models, including one that examines whether average ratings exceed certain thresholds (4.4 or 4.5), and suggested focusing initially on calculating sentiment as a key outcome variable.

Sentiment Analysis Research Collaboration

Bhargab and Francis discussed a research project focused on validating sentiment scores using BART and potentially involving a co-author. Bhargab suggested Kovac as a potential collaborator but left the decision open to Francis, who could propose alternative candidates. Bhargab emphasized that the research should be approached from an IES perspective rather than a marketing angle. Francis agreed to review the paper and complete sentiment analysis before providing further input on the project's direction.

Data Variables and Abbreviations Discussion

Bhargab and Francis discussed data variables and abbreviations used in their dataset. Bhargab offered to provide full forms for the short forms used in the data and mentioned sending Francis a dictionary to match with CP_RVS. They also discussed how language conversion might affect data matching, particularly regarding Chinese to English translations.

Data Scraping and IOP Feedback

Bhargab discussed issues with data scraping and duplicate entries in a review system, explaining how he identified and handled repeated reviews from the same reviewer. He mentioned that he

would send Francis a dictionary by the weekend for review. Regarding the IOP project, Bhargab provided feedback on a draft, noting that while the methodology and literature review were well done, the introduction lacked theoretical motivation for comparing different time periods. He suggested including hypotheses about changes in IOP between rural and urban areas based on interventions or literature, and requested that Francis review the updated draft before their next meeting.

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